HOORVIA - STEAK DONENESS CHART: INTERNAL TEMPS, PULL TEMPS & TOUCH TEST

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Kitchen & Cooking

Blue / Extra-Rare			
Pull From Heat At	**Final Rested Temp**	**Visual Center Description**	**Mouthfeel & Juiciness**
110°F / 43°C	115°F / 46°C	Deep purple-red; cool center	Very soft, spongy, raw-like core

Rare			
Pull From Heat At	**Final Rested Temp**	**Visual Center Description**	**Mouthfeel & Juiciness**
120°F / 49°C	125°F / 52°C	Bright ruby red across 75% of center	Very tender, abundant red juices

Medium-Rare (Chef Standard)			
Pull From Heat At	**Final Rested Temp**	**Visual Center Description**	**Mouthfeel & Juiciness**
130°F / 54°C	135°F / 57°C	Warm red center with pink halo	Buttery, maximum flavor & melted fat

Medium			
Pull From Heat At	**Final Rested Temp**	**Visual Center Description**	**Mouthfeel & Juiciness**
140°F / 60°C	145°F / 63°C (USDA)	Rose pink throughout center	Firm bite, moderately juicy

Medium-Well			
Pull From Heat At	**Final Rested Temp**	**Visual Center Description**	**Mouthfeel & Juiciness**
150°F / 66°C	155°F / 68°C	Thin sliver of light pink in middle	Chewy, noticeably drier

Well-Done			
Pull From Heat At	**Final Rested Temp**	**Visual Center Description**	**Mouthfeel & Juiciness**
155°F / 68°C	160°F+ / 71°C+	100% brown edge-to-edge; zero pink	Firm, dense, minimal natural moisture

PRO TIP: When you sear a steak over a 500°F cast-iron skillet or charcoal grill grate, a steep thermal gradient forms between the sizzling 350°F exterior crust and the cool 130°F center. The moment you remove the steak from the pan, physics takes over: heat flows from the hot outer shell into the cooler core until the steak reaches thermal equilibrium. On a standard 1.25-inch ribeye or strip, this carryover cooking raises the internal temperature by 5°F to 7°F over 6 minutes. On a thick 2-inch bone-in cowboy steak, carryover can climb by 8°F to 10°F.